



WaveBase

BRAND BOARD · v1 · MAY 2026

*The honest surf guide,
made consistent.*

For Lode De Waegenare & Michiel De Cooman

Prepared by Claude

00 — POSITIONING

What this brand feels like.

Honest. Editorial. Warm.

Three feelings the visual system has to evoke — every time, on every surface.

01 — HONEST

Honest

No marketing adjectives, no stock photos, no hidden weak spots. The visual must feel as truthful as the copy reads.

02 — EDITORIAL

Editorial

Closer to a surf-travel zine than a booking grid. Generous white-space, serif headers, blog-like layout. Warm.

03 — WARM

Warm

Cream paper, sun-baked clay, ocean teal. Hand-mixed, not digital. Soft edges, organic curves. A friend's house, not a resort lobby.

What we are explicitly NOT

- × Not a booking-platform
- × Not action-sport extreme
- × Not minimal startup

Booking.com / BookSurfCamps cold blue + sterile grid. Sterility = distrust.
Red Bull / Quiksilver loud red-yellow + carbon. We're surf travel, not surf-as-spectacle.
Linear / Notion white + black + one accent. Too cold, too tech, too anonymous.

Reference points

The mental images we're closer to than the bullets above:

- A well-designed surf-travel zine — paper, generous margins, photo essays, real voice.
- The inside of a Moroccan riad — cream walls, clay accents, wooden details, warm light.
- A Greek-island taverna at golden hour — cream linen, terracotta tiles, sea visible from the table.
- Wearetravellers.nl — the reference site Lode flagged at the start. Editorial travel, not a grid.

01 — LOGO

Wordmark, icon, safe space.



Favicon / app icon — square, rounded corners, scales to any size.

WaveBase

Primary wordmark — "Wave" in Ink, "Base" in Sea. Times Bold / Fraunces equivalent.



Inverse on Sea — "Wave" in Cream, "Base" in Sand-deep. For dark surfaces.



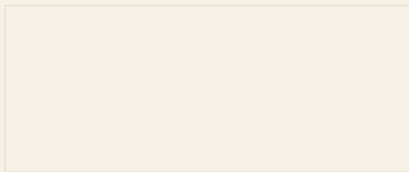
Safe space — keep clear area equal to the cap-height of "W" on all sides.

02 — COLOR PALETTE

Twelve colors, three roles each.

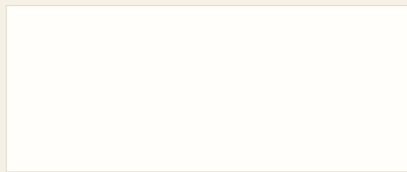
WHAT THIS PALETTE EVOKES

Sun-baked Mediterranean surf town. Cream paper, clay-tile walls, ocean horizon, sand on the floor — not the cold blue of a tech book.

**Cream**

#F6F1E7

Page background, the warm canvas

**Paper**

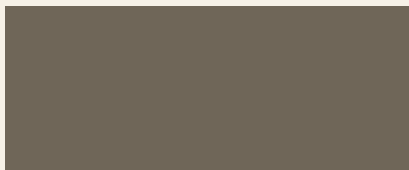
#FFFEFB

Cards, surfaces that need contrast

**Ink**

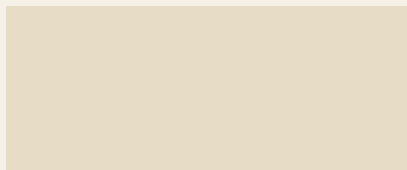
#2A2723

Primary text, headlines

**Ink-soft**

#6F6658

Secondary text, captions, muted UI

**Sand**

#E7DCC4

Dividers, soft borders, table rules

**Sand-deep**

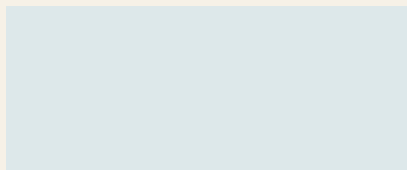
#D8C9A8

Wave accents, highlight underline behind hero text

**Sea**

#3F6F7D

Primary action / links / surf-spot identity color

**Sea-soft**

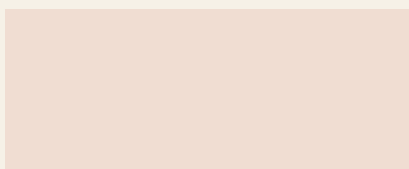
#DDE8EA

Active select background, hover state

**Clay**

#BD6242

CTA buttons, accents, stay identity color

**Clay-soft**

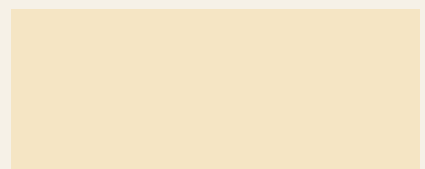
#F0DDD2

Soft accents, muted clay tone

**Amber**

#E0A447

Surf-center identity color, tertiary accent

**Amber-soft**

#F5E5C4

Soft amber wash for accents

Usage rules

- Sea, Clay, Amber = the three identity colors for spot / stay / center. Don't reassign.
- Cream is the page background. Paper is for cards. Never the other way around.
- Sand-deep highlight (the underline behind "honestly" in the hero) is reserved for that one accent.
- Soft variants are for hover / active states only — not for primary fill.

03 — TYPOGRAPHY

Two families, clear hierarchy.

WHAT THESE TYPEFACES EVOKE

Fraunces has personality — a warm modern serif with subtle quirks (the W has italic flair, the optical sizing keeps it readable). Not a stuffy old-newspaper serif. DM Sans is humanist — feels like a human wrote it, not a marketing team.

Fraunces

Serif · Google Fonts · weights 500 & 600 · optical sizes 9–144. Fallback: Georgia Bold / Times Bold.

For: page titles, hero headlines, section headers, the WaveBase wordmark.

Surfing, told honestly

34pt

The honest friend

22pt

Section header

15pt

Inline serif accent

11pt

DM Sans

Sans · Google Fonts · weights 400, 500, 600. Fallback: Helvetica / Arial.

For: body text, captions, buttons, navigation, all UI labels.

Button or large label

16pt

Body lead

12pt

Body text — what surfers actually read

10pt

Caption · metadata

8pt

Italic Fraunces — taglines and pull quotes only. Sparingly.

04 — SHAPES & PATTERNS

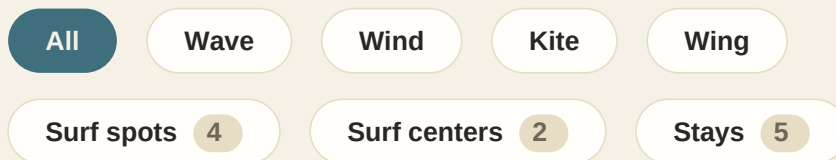
Pills, cards, waves, dots.

WHAT THESE SHAPES EVOKE

Curves over corners. Wave-shaped paths echo what we write about — literal motion of water. Rounded pills feel thumb-friendly on mobile, soft on the eye, never aggressive. The sand-deep underline is an editor's mark, not a link.

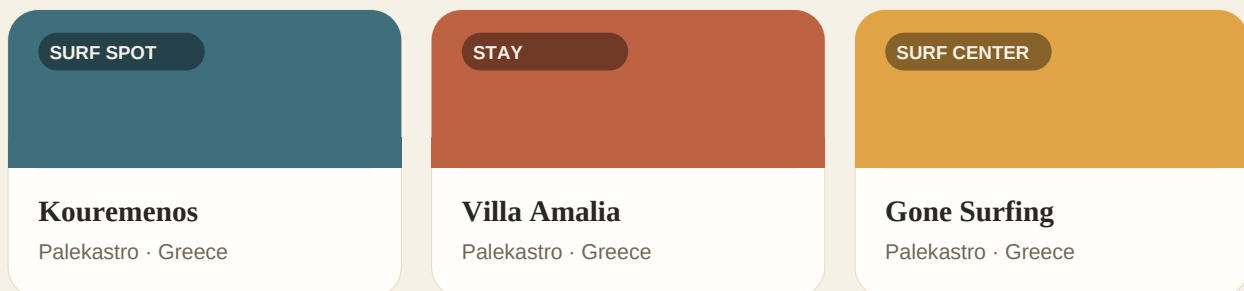
Sport pills · section-jumper chips

Border-radius 999px. DM Sans 600 · 14pt · padding 9×18.



Cards

Border-radius 18px. Paper bg, soft shadow. Color thumb tag identifies type.



Wave pattern

Two-color stack. Sand-deep behind Clay. Echoes the favicon and the OG image.



05 — LABELS & ACCENTS

Source-strength, sport, country.

Source-strength labels

Used on every spot / stay / center to flag how confident the source-grounding is.

**SOLID**

Multiple independent recent sources agree.

**MOSTLY SOLID**

Real but recent coverage is thin.

**STALE**

Only older reviews exist. Honest about being dated.

Map markers

Three identity colors. Same logic used on cards, badges, filter dots.



Surf spot



Stay



Surf center

Hero underline accent

Sand-deep horizontal band behind the emphasized word in the hero. Used sparingly — one word, hero only.

Surfing, told **honestly**.

06 — VOICE & TONE

How we sound, and why.

The core voice

“The honest friend who's been there and tells you the truth.”

Always

- First-person plural (“we”, “Lode and Michiel”). Never third-person corporate.
- Specific over generic. “30 m to the sand”, not “close to the beach”.
- Numbers when we have them. “4.4 / 5 over 10 reviews”, not “popular”.
- Honest minpunten section in every stay or center. The negatives sit visible.
- Direct review quotes — dated, never named (“a Sep 2025 reviewer”, not “Karsten”).
- Source-strength labels on every entry. ■■■ — never optional.
- English for user-facing copy. Dutch for project notes and internal voice.

Never

- Marketing adjectives without evidence. (“Stunning! Unique! Amazing!”)
- Reviewer first names. Privacy + adds no value over the date.
- Older-than-4-years reviews presented as current evidence.
- Hiding a property's weak spots because we earn affiliate on it.
- Generic stock photos pretending to be the spot. Slot the placeholder until a real photo lands.
- Corporate “team” voice. There's no team — there's Lode and Michiel.

“We write about every place we can verify with reviews — regardless of whether we can monetise it. The affiliate sits on top, never inside.”

— The wedge rule